

MMT2

IT Strategic Solutions

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A regional online grocer with 80 employees, founded in 2015, is doing a SWOT analysis. Its order-routing software is 12 years old and slows down badly when orders spike on holidays. The grocer won a local business award last year. In which SWOT category does the aging software belong?

- A. Weakness.
- B. Opportunity, because it can be replaced.
- C. Threat, because it could cause outages.
- D. Strength, because it has run for 12 years.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which item belongs in the threats box of a mid-size logistics firm's SWOT analysis?

- A. Its IT staff lacks cloud skills.
- B. A major rival has gone out of business, leaving customers to win.
- C. A new data-privacy law in a key market will raise compliance costs.
- D. Its routing algorithm is patented.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A CIO at a building-supply distributor has documented the current state: orders are keyed in by hand and take two days to ship. The desired state is automated order entry with same-day shipping. At a trade conference, a peer CIO praised a particular ERP vendor. What is the next step in the gap analysis?

- A. Select a vendor and begin implementation.
- B. Lower the desired state until it matches current capabilities.
- C. Identify the specific gaps in process, people and technology between the two states.
- D. Buy the ERP system the peer CIO recommended.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A company's server room, in a building built in 1985, holds equipment worth \$400,000. A flood would damage about 25% of it. Floods of that size are expected about once every five years. The company's insurance broker recently changed. What is the annualized loss expectancy?

- A. \$80,000
- B. \$500,000
- C. \$100,000
- D. \$20,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A security control costs \$15,000 a year and cuts a risk's annualized loss expectancy from \$50,000 to \$20,000. What is the control's net annual benefit?

- A. \$30,000
- B. \$15,000
- C. \$45,000
- D. \$35,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

Ransomware encrypted the scheduling system at a clinic with 14 physicians. Forensic review showed no patient data was copied or changed, but staff could not open any appointments for two days. The clinic had just renewed its cyber-insurance policy. Which part of the CIA triad was mainly harmed?

- A. Confidentiality.
- B. Integrity.
- C. Availability.
- D. All three equally, because ransomware always breaches all three.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which control mainly protects the integrity of data?

- A.** Keeping redundant servers in a second data center.
- B.** Hashing files so any unauthorized change can be detected.
- C.** A firewall, which fully protects all three.
- D.** Encrypting data at rest.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A growing company is choosing a system. Option A is an on-premises server costing \$60,000 up front plus \$15,000 a year for maintenance and support staff. Option B is a SaaS subscription at \$30,000 a year. The SaaS vendor was founded in 2019 and has strong online reviews. Over three years, which option has the lower total cost of ownership, and by how much?

- A.** Option A, by \$15,000.
- B.** Option A, by \$30,000.
- C.** Option A, because owning is always cheaper over time.
- D.** Option B, by \$15,000.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An on-premises system costs \$80,000 up front plus \$10,000 a year. A subscription costs \$30,000 a year. After how many years are their cumulative costs equal?

- A.** 8 years
- B.** 4 years
- C.** 2.7 years
- D.** 2 years

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A startup that recently raised \$4 million has 25 developers working remotely in three countries. It wants to write and deploy its own application code but does not want to manage servers, operating systems, patches or the runtime. Which cloud service model fits?

- A.** Software as a Service (SaaS).
- B.** An on-premises private data center.
- C.** Infrastructure as a Service (IaaS).
- D.** Platform as a Service (PaaS).

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

An online retailer based in Ohio, with no offices outside the state, begins selling and shipping to customers in Germany and France. All its customer data is stored in U.S. data centers, and its CTO prefers a single cloud provider. Which statement about the EU's GDPR is accurate?

- A.** GDPR can apply, because the retailer offers goods to people in the EU.
- B.** GDPR applies only if the data is stored on servers in the EU.
- C.** GDPR applies to every U.S. company, whether or not it has EU customers.
- D.** GDPR does not apply, because the company has no EU office.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A CIO must brief the board of directors on a planned migration of 140 servers to the cloud. The engineering team is excited about moving to containers and Kubernetes. What should the CIO's message to the board focus on?

- A.** Business outcomes: cost, risk, timeline and how the migration supports strategy.
- B.** Nothing until the migration is complete, to avoid confusion.
- C.** The same detailed message given to every stakeholder group.
- D.** The container and Kubernetes architecture in detail.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A regional online grocer ~~with 80 employees, founded in 2015,~~ is doing a SWOT analysis. Its order-routing software is 12 years old and slows down badly when orders spike on holidays. ~~The grocer won a local business award last year.~~ In which SWOT category does the aging software belong?

Target word: SWOT category **Decides:** The software is inside the company and hurts performance.

A	Correct	An internal limitation the company controls is a weakness.
B	Inverted operation	Reads the fix as the factor; opportunities are favorable external conditions.
C	Adjacent category	Threats are external; this problem sits inside the firm.
D	Confusion set	Longevity is not a strength when the system cannot handle demand.

2. Answer C Concept 1 • transfer

Which item belongs in the threats box of a mid-size logistics firm's SWOT analysis?

Target word: an external negative **Decides:** Threats are external and unfavorable.

A	Adjacent category	Internal and negative: a weakness.
B	Inverted operation	External but favorable: an opportunity.
C	Correct	An outside change that can hurt the firm is a threat.
D	Confusion set	Internal and positive: a strength.

3. Answer C Concept 2

A CIO at a building-supply distributor has documented the current state: orders are keyed in by hand and take two days to ship. The desired state is automated order entry with same-day shipping. ~~At a trade conference, a peer CIO praised a particular ERP vendor.~~ What is the next step in the gap analysis?

Target word: next step **Decides:** Current and desired states are both defined; the gaps are not.

A	Dropped element	Skips identifying the gaps.
B	Inverted operation	Moves the goal to the problem instead of closing the gap.
C	Correct	Gaps must be named before actions to close them can be chosen.
D	Camouflage	Answers the conference detail; a solution comes after gaps are known.

4. Answer D Concept 3

A company's server room, ~~in a building built in 1985,~~ holds equipment worth \$400,000. A flood would damage about 25% of it. Floods of that size are expected about once every five years. ~~The company's insurance broker recently changed.~~ What is the annualized loss expectancy?

Target word: ALE **Decides:** $SLE = \$400,000 \times 0.25$; $ARO = 1/5 = 0.2$.

A	Wrong stem number	Applies the rate to the full \$400,000 instead of the SLE.
B	Inverted operation	Divides the SLE by 0.2 instead of multiplying.
C	Dropped element	That is the single loss expectancy; the annual rate is missing.
D	Correct	$SLE = \$100,000$; $ALE = \$100,000 \times 0.2 = \$20,000$.

5. Answer B Concept 3 • transfer

A security control costs \$15,000 a year and cuts a risk's annualized loss expectancy from \$50,000 to \$20,000. What is the control's net annual benefit?

Target word: net benefit of a control **Decides:** Benefit = ALE before – ALE after – annual cost.

A	Dropped element	Leaves out the control's cost.
B	Correct	$\$50,000 - \$20,000 - \$15,000 = \$15,000$.
C	Inverted operation	Adds the control cost instead of subtracting it.
D	Wrong stem number	$\$50,000 - \$15,000$ ignores the ALE that remains.

6. Answer C Concept 4

Ransomware encrypted the scheduling system at a clinic ~~with 14 physicians~~. Forensic review showed no patient data was copied or changed, but staff could not open any appointments for two days. ~~The clinic had just renewed its cyber insurance policy.~~ Which part of the CIA triad was mainly harmed?

Target word: which CIA principle **Decides:** Staff lost access; nothing was exposed or altered.

A	Confusion set	No data was copied or exposed.
B	Adjacent category	Nothing was changed; forensic review confirmed that.
C	Correct	The data could not be reached when needed.
D	Absolute language	Ransomware effects vary; here only access was lost.

7. Answer B Concept 4 • transfer

Which control mainly protects the integrity of data?

Target word: an integrity control **Decides:** Integrity = detecting or preventing unauthorized change.

A	Adjacent category	Redundancy protects availability.
B	Correct	A changed hash shows the data was altered.
C	Absolute language	No single control fully protects every principle.
D	Confusion set	Encryption mainly protects confidentiality.

8. Answer D Concept 5

A growing company is choosing a system. Option A is an on-premises server costing \$60,000 up front plus \$15,000 a year for maintenance and support staff. Option B is a SaaS subscription at \$30,000 a year. ~~The SaaS vendor was founded in 2019 and has strong online reviews.~~ Over three years, which option has the lower total cost of ownership, and by how much?

Target word: lower three-year TCO **Decides:** $A = \$60,000 + 3 \times \$15,000 = \$105,000$; $B = 3 \times \$30,000 = \$90,000$.

A	Inverted operation	Right gap, wrong direction.
B	Dropped element	Compares A's \$60,000 purchase price with B's \$90,000, dropping A's maintenance.
C	Absolute language	Ownership is cheaper only past a break-even point; here it is not.
D	Correct	$\$105,000 - \$90,000 = \$15,000$.

9. Answer B Concept 5 • transfer

An on-premises system costs \$80,000 up front plus \$10,000 a year. A subscription costs \$30,000 a year. After how many years are their cumulative costs equal?

Target word: break-even year **Decides:** Annual savings of owning = \$30,000 – \$10,000 = \$20,000.

A	Wrong stem number	\$80,000 / \$10,000 divides by the maintenance cost alone.
B	Correct	\$80,000 / \$20,000 = 4; both total \$120,000 after four years.
C	Dropped element	\$80,000 / \$30,000 ignores the \$10,000 yearly cost of owning.
D	Inverted operation	\$80,000 / \$40,000 adds the two yearly costs instead of taking the difference.

10. Answer D Concept 6

A startup ~~that recently raised \$4 million~~ has 25 developers ~~working remotely in three countries~~. It wants to write and deploy its own application code but does not want to manage servers, operating systems, patches or the runtime. Which cloud service model fits?

Target word: cloud model **Decides:** They manage only code and data.

A	Inverted operation	SaaS delivers finished software; there is no code of their own to deploy.
B	Confusion set	That maximizes what the startup must manage.
C	Adjacent category	With IaaS the customer still manages the OS and runtime.
D	Correct	The provider manages infrastructure, OS and runtime; the customer deploys code.

11. Answer A Concept 7

An online retailer based in Ohio, with no offices outside the state, begins selling and shipping to customers in Germany and France. All its customer data is stored in U.S. data centers, ~~and its CTO prefers a single cloud provider~~. Which statement about the EU's GDPR is accurate?

Target word: does GDPR reach this firm **Decides:** It offers goods to people in the EU.

A	Correct	GDPR reaches firms outside the EU that offer goods or services to people in the EU.
B	Adjacent category	Server location does not decide coverage.
C	Absolute language	Coverage depends on processing data of people in the EU.
D	Dropped element	Drops the customers' location, which is what brings the firm under GDPR.

12. Answer A Concept 8

A CIO must brief the board of directors on a planned migration of 140 servers to the cloud. ~~The engineering team is excited about moving to containers and Kubernetes~~. What should the CIO's message to the board focus on?

Target word: content for the board **Decides:** The audience is the board.

A	Correct	Executives need the business case, not technical detail.
B	Inverted operation	Communication plans inform stakeholders before and during change, not after.
C	Dropped element	Drops the audience analysis at the heart of a communication plan.
D	Camouflage	Answers the engineering detail; that suits the technical team.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	7	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	3	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	5	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	2	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	SWOT: internal vs. external	Strengths and weaknesses are internal and controllable; opportunities and threats are external conditions in the environment.	Calling an internal problem a threat because it is dangerous.	Whether the factor sits inside the company or in the market, law or competition.
2	Gap analysis	Document the current state, define the desired state, identify the specific gaps, then plan actions to close them.	Jumping from the desired state straight to buying a solution.	Current and future states described, and a question about the next step.
3	Quantitative risk: SLE and ALE	$SLE = \text{asset value} \times \text{exposure factor}$; $ALE = SLE \times \text{annual rate of occurrence}$.	Using the full asset value, or stopping at the single loss.	An asset value, a percentage damaged, and how often per year.
4	The CIA triad	Confidentiality keeps data from unauthorized eyes, integrity keeps it accurate and unaltered, availability keeps it reachable when needed.	Assuming every attack is a confidentiality breach.	What the harm was: exposure, alteration, or lost access.
5	Total cost of ownership	Compare options on all costs over the same period: purchase, maintenance, staff, licensing and operations.	Comparing only the purchase price with a subscription.	Up-front costs and recurring costs over several years.
6	Cloud service models	IaaS: you manage OS and up; PaaS: you manage only your code and data; SaaS: you use finished software.	Mixing up who manages the operating system and runtime.	What the customer still wants to build or manage.
7	Global data protection	Laws such as the EU's GDPR follow the people whose data is processed, so a firm without local offices can still be covered.	Assuming only the law where the company or its servers sit applies.	A company in one country serving customers in another.
8	Audience-based communication plans	Tailor the message to each audience: executives get business outcomes, risks and costs; technical teams get technical detail.	Sending the same technical message to every stakeholder.	A presentation to a board or executives about a technical project.

Course scope (public description): IT Strategic Solutions guides students in identifying strategic opportunities and emerging technologies through research and deciding on a system to support a growing company. Topics will include technology strategy; gap analysis; researching new technology; strengths, opportunities, weaknesses, and threats; ethics; risk mitigation; data security, communication plans; and globalization.